

The world has to look like it was drawn by whoever drew the Catchmons.

Warm, stylised, magical-adventurous 2.5D collector world: clean readable outlines, soft cel-painterly shading, large simple volumes, warm materials, elemental colour used as an accent — never as a wash. Cute and cool sit side by side. Nothing is realistic, nothing is grimdark, nothing is childish. Catchmons stay the emotional stars; every other asset frames them.

FORM RATIO

60–70% soft/round · 20–30% clean/angular · 10% sharp/magical. Round = shop, care, food. Angular = tools, stone, steel, expedition. Sharp = magic, rarity, power.

SILHOUETTE LAW

1–3 dominant silhouette features per asset, separated volumes, readable with all interior detail removed. Must still read at 64 px, icons at 20–24 px.

HIERARCHY OF CONTRAST

UI > interactive object > props > environment > far background. Backgrounds are always less saturated, lower contrast and less detailed than the thing you can touch.

1 • The rendering recipe

These six settings are the style. If an asset misses one of them it will read as a different art team, no matter how good it is.

Outline — visible and deliberate, medium weight, heavier outside than inside. Dark but almost never pure black: tint it toward the material. No hairline anime lineart, no hard comic ink, no outline-free semi-realism.

Shading — soft cel-painterly. One clearly directed, slightly warm key light; large connected shadow shapes; no AO grime, no noise, no micro-texture.

Highlights — 1-2 dominant per object, material-dependent. Diffuse on fur and cloth, tight on metal and glass, strongest on magic. Never a realistic specular.

Material by shape, not texture — stone reads through faceted planes, fur through soft volume transitions, energy through glow and colour contrast. Simplified wood grain, stylised metal, translucent glass where the contents out-read the glass.

Camera — products and props at one shared 3/4 angle; shop and stations in a soft elevated 3/4 2.5D diorama; regions layered fore/mid/background.

Glow — elemental energy, active selection, masterwork, discovery, capture. Nowhere else. Core glows, surrounding form stays legible; no permanent bloom, no glowing buttons.

ALWAYS

Large legible masses · rounded base forms with targeted angular accents · warm harmonious palettes · depth through layering and light · elemental colour as accent · one small asymmetric detail for personality · visible craft and shop life · quiet space between important information.

NEVER

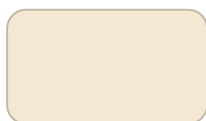
Photoreal texture or PBR materiality · thin lines · dirty grimdark palettes · neon everywhere · permanently glowing UI · flat generic mobile-game cards without depth · sci-fi HUD framing · MMO gold frames on everything · glossy anime eyes on every character · random radii and shadows · props rendered more realistically than a Catchmon · backgrounds that out-contrast the interactive object.

2 • Colour

One warm base family carries the whole game. Element colour enters as accent, symbol, glow or silhouette change — it never repaints an asset. Max 2-3 accent layers per card, and status is never communicated by colour alone.



Neutral Dark
#2E2A28 · text,
outline



Soft Cream
#F5E8D2 · panels



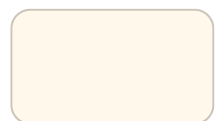
Warm Sand
#D8B882 · surfaces



Muted Walnut
#7B573D · wood,
borders



Soft Gold
#E7B85A · premium



Warm White
#FFF8EB · highlights

Success #65B97A
Warning #E6A94C
Error #D96868
Info #67A9D8

Premium #E6B958
Disabled #8E8984

ELEMENT COMPASS · PRIMARY / SECONDARY / GLOW

Fire · lava, embers

Water · waves, coral

Electric · veins, bolts

Grass · oversized flora

Earth · strata, rock

Poison · fungi, vapour

Normal · open land

Ice · crystal, frost

Fairy · light motes

Wind · arcs, plains

Steel · ore, geology

Psychic · floating forms

Light · beams, monoliths

Dark · deep shadow

Ghost · mist, transparency

Dragon · monumental rock

Cosmic · stars, voids

3 • What the references prove

The existing Catchmons already define the width of the style. Every new asset has to sit inside this band — not below it, not above it.



Terranox — the angular / heroic end. Faceted stone volumes, warm earth palette, ground debris as part of the silhouette.



Zapkit — the cute end. Two-tone flat masses, one element symbol, no micro-detail at all.



Glissalune — elegant translucency. Colour does the material work; the outline still holds the whole form.



Metallino — stylised metal ceiling: few large soft reflections, zero brushed-metal texture.



Echolurne — mystical without grimdark. Glow confined to eyes and sigils; cloth stays matte and soft.



Voidalon — the darkest, most imposing legal point. Still flat masses, still one accent hue, still collectible.

4 • Golden Samples, prioritised

Three waves. Nothing scales to mass production before Wave 1 is signed off, because Wave 1 is what every later asset is measured against.

WAVE 1 Style lock — 5 assets defines outline weight, light temperature, saturation ceiling, camera		
SAMPLE	SPEC	WHAT IT MUST SETTLE
Shop Key Environment + one Catchmon in frame	2048×1536, opaque, 3/4 elevated	Light temperature, material palette, zone reading, and whether world and creature share one rendering language.
Provision Station	1024 ² , alpha, idle+active	Round/warm/craft archetype, station state language, wood-ceramic-brass treatment.
Standard Product (a Provision)	1024 ² , alpha, 3/4	Object scale, safe margin, shadow convention, the 64-96 px readability floor.
Product Card + Button Set	1x mobile frame, 390 wide	Radii, borders, shadows, hierarchy, how UI stays world-derived without going skeuomorphic.
Coin Icon	512 ² , alpha, +24 px test	Icon stroke logic, optical mass, and the minted-not-sparkly currency read.

WAVE 2 System proof — 6 assets proves the locked style stretches across categories	
Fieldworks Bench — the angular/robust station archetype against the round one.	Display Furniture — proves the frame can stay quieter than the product it holds.
Premium Product — Fine/Masterwork treatment on the same base artwork.	Routine Material — the low-decoration, instant-recognition floor.
Special Component — element identity without going legendary.	Customer — human charm that stays subordinate to a Catchmon.

WAVE 3 World & motion — 5 assets only meaningful once the shop language is fixed	
Region Background — layered diorama, UI safe areas, element beyond colour.	Route Card — the reduced-detail derivative of region key art.
Masterwork Effect — overlay-only premium, no repainted artwork.	Capture Effect — focus ring, energy draw-in, burst; tense, not combative.
Momentum Icon + World UI Context — momentum must never read as a second currency.	

RECOMMENDATION • FIRST ASSET TO GENERATE

Shop Key Environment with one existing Catchmon standing in it.

It is the only sample where the world and a signed-off creature share the same pixels, so it settles the six decisions everything else inherits — outline weight at environment scale, key-light direction and warmth, the saturation ceiling for backgrounds, the 3/4 diorama camera, the wood/sandstone/ceramic/cloth material read, and the cute-plus-cool balance of the space. Every later asset can then be judged by holding it against this one frame instead of against prose.

Brief: Sales Floor and Workshop zone visible, one warm local light source plus soft ambient, 2–3 props per zone maximum, background walls desaturated below the counters, foreground floor left clear for UI, Terranox or Badgy composited at true relative scale, no gold framing, no glow except one small rune core on a shelf. Deliver base / shadow / glow layers separately.

5 • Generation contract

Every asset request carries the same style block plus one category modifier. This is what keeps a hundred assets in one world.

BASE STYLE BLOCK — ALWAYS INCLUDED VERBATIM

Stylised 2D game illustration, clean deliberate outline of medium weight, dark warm-tinted line rather than pure black, soft cel-painterly shading with one directed slightly warm key light, large connected shadow shapes, 1–2 controlled highlights, simplified stylised materials with no photoreal texture, warm harmonious palette, strong readable silhouette, minimal micro-detail, mobile-legible, charming high-quality collectible feel, not realistic, not grimdark, not childish, no neon, no lens flare, no PBR, no gold ornament frames.

Products + shared 3/4 product angle, 1024², transparent, generous safe margin, single centred object, optional separate soft ground shadow.

Materials & components + single clear object, natural colour code, element hint only for special components.

Regions + layered fore/mid/background, one dominant landform, 1–2 element cues in form not just colour, UI space left empty, lower contrast than interactive objects.

Stations & displays + 3/4 elevated, craft materials, one working component for the active state, lower saturation than the product on top.

Customers + stylised humanoid, slightly larger head and hands, reduced facial detail, cozy-adventure clothing, silhouette quieter than any Catchmon.

Icons + single silhouette, medium uniform stroke, no fine interior lines, readable at 20–24 px, matched optical mass across the set.

ASSET RECORD — FILL BEFORE GENERATING

AssetId · category · where it is used · target size ·
transparency · camera angle · safe margin · variants ·
required states · animated yes/no · Golden Sample
reference.

Naming:

cms_[category]_[name]_[variant]_[state]@1024.png

— e.g. cms_prod_berrycake_std_base@1024.png

REVIEW GATE — 8 CHECKS, ANY FAIL = REWORK

Believable beside a Catchmon · silhouette readable
at 64 px · material stylised enough · outline
consistent with the family · saturation under
control · no realistic highlights · no needless micro-
detail · magic targeted, not ambient.

Decision rule: “Would this asset believably exist in the same world as our Catchmons?” If the answer is not clearly yes, itArt Brief gets reworked.

v1